

How to do Paper 1 Sourcework in IB History

Recommended timings: Q1: 10 min; Q2: 10 min; Q3 15 min; Q4 20 min (leave 5m for checking)

1a	Why, according to source ____, did....	How to write the answer - The first reason given by the source is that [...] - The second reason given by the source is that [...] - The third reason given by the source is that [...] Markscheme - Award a mark for each <i>valid</i> reason provided from the source - A <i>valid</i> reason is a deduction/inference (note: not a paraphrase!!) which is backed up by detail from the source (e.g. quotes) - Try to get into the habit of “explain, then quote” (e.g. “One reason is that Eden was afraid that Nasser would damage the British economy when he said “we cannot let him have his thumb on our windpipe.”)	3 marks
1b	What message is conveyed by source ____?	How to write the answer - One message conveyed by the source is that [...], because the source shows [...] - A second message conveyed by the source is that [...], because the source shows [...] Markscheme - Award one mark for each valid message given based on the source - Valid = backed up by detail from the source - Message = a deduction, not just a paraphrase then repeated with the actual quote! - Try to get into the habit of “explain, then quote” (e.g. “One message is that Moshe Dayan was keen for a clash with the Arabs as seen by the provocative signs held by the Israelis in the cartoon.”)	2 marks
2	With reference to its origin, purpose and content, analyze the value and limitations of Source A for a historian studying....	How to write the answer - The origin of source A is _____. From this we can deduce that its purpose is _____. The language used in the content _____. - Therefore, the origin of the source is valuable because _____. For example, in terms of its content, it is valuable _____ (focus on facts provided and attitudes revealed) - Nevertheless, it also has some limitations in the sense that _____. For example, a limitation in terms of its content is because _____ (focus on factual omissions and unfair prejudices) Markscheme 0 marks: The source is summarized 1 mark: Answers rely only on generic points (e.g. “its in an election speech so it might be biased; it is a diary so it can be trusted”) 1-2 marks: Only value OR limitations are considered 3-4 marks: The source is assessed well (explicit focus on this particular source rather than ‘stock’ comments about OPVL) **TIP: Each source must always be assessed on its own merits and as specifically as possible. Base your points on specific things about the particular source based on its content, origin, and purpose (quotes are useful to illustrate tone)	4 marks

	Value	Limitations
Origins <i>(When, where, by whom was it made?)</i>	Primary Sources: first hand knowledge of events described, indication of opinion at the time. e.g. diaries, newspapers, cartoons Secondary sources: provide hindsight and objectivity. e.g. works of histories, textbooks	Primary sources: Too subjective, miss ‘big picture’, sometimes subject to censorship Secondary sources: Narrow depth study. Superficial overview. Biased historian.
Purpose <i>Intent, to inform or to persuade)</i>	Facts: dry, objective sources give data to be checked against other sources to provide conclusions Opinions: biased, subjective sources give an insight into the attitudes of the time	Facts: censorship - a factual account can be misleading if it leaves out “inconvenient truths” Opinions: Prejudiced propaganda misleads the reader about the popularity of a regime’s policies

3	Compare and contrast the views on ____ stated in sources B & C	How to write the answer • In terms of comparison, both sources agree that [...]. Source C says that ____ and source D says that ____ • The sources also agree that [...]. Source C says that ____ and source D says that ____ • However, in terms of contrast, the sources disagree about [...]. Source C says that ____ whereas source D says that ____ • The spruces also disagree about [...]. While source C says ____ Source D says that ____. Markscheme • If only one document is addressed, a maximum of 2 marks is awarded • If the two documents are discussed separately, 3 marks can be awarded or with excellent linkage, 4 marks. • For 4-5 marks, expect to write a running comparison with points that identify superficial comparisons (“both sources agree that the Suez Crisis was in 1956”) or contrasts which dwell on things mentioned by one source which are merely omitted in another (“source A says Nasser travels by car. Source B does not mention this.”) • For 5-6 marks, expect to write a detailed running comparison that makes sharp, substantiated, meaningful points. Notes • There is no strict need to explain why the sources agree or disagree - merely how they do so - but a brief closing segment on this is worthwhile. • Try to get into the habit of “explain, then quote” (e.g. “The source says that Nasser was dangerous for wold peace, saying ‘the Hitler of the Nile’”)	6 marks																
4	Using the sources and your own knowledge, explain to what extent you agree with the statement: “____”	How to write the answer • A section providing one interpretation, with a blend of sources (described and evaluated) and background knowledge • Sections providing a second (and even third) interpretation in the same format • A conclusion which - Identifies a particular source which provides the most sophisticated answer and explains why this is the ‘best’. - Addresses how an answer depends on factors like when/where/at whom you are looking - Picks fault with loaded words in the questions like “totally”, “Mainly”, “brutal” and suggest better ones. Markscheme (award 1-3 points for each row of the table below, up to a maximum of 9 marks) ***See Chart Below																	
		<table> <tr> <th></th><th>1 Mark Lacks focus on the question</th><th>2 Marks Generally focused on the question</th><th>3 Marks Clearly focused on the question</th></tr> <tr> <th>Sources</th><td>Sources are not used or are summarized rather than applied to the demands of the question</td><td>Content of sources is used descriptively to address the question (their reliability is not commented upon)</td><td>Content of sources is used analytically to address the question (their reliability is evaluated)</td></tr> <tr> <th>Background Knowledge</th><td>Background knowledge is generally vague, inaccurate and/or irrelevant</td><td>Background knowledge is accurate but its relevance is not clearly established</td><td>Background knowledge is accurate and effectively supports the analysis</td></tr> <tr> <th>Style</th><td>There is no attempt to integrate sources and background knowledge</td><td>There is little attempt to integrate sources and background knoweldge</td><td>There is a sustained integration of sources and background knowledge</td></tr> </table>		1 Mark Lacks focus on the question	2 Marks Generally focused on the question	3 Marks Clearly focused on the question	Sources	Sources are not used or are summarized rather than applied to the demands of the question	Content of sources is used descriptively to address the question (their reliability is not commented upon)	Content of sources is used analytically to address the question (their reliability is evaluated)	Background Knowledge	Background knowledge is generally vague, inaccurate and/or irrelevant	Background knowledge is accurate but its relevance is not clearly established	Background knowledge is accurate and effectively supports the analysis	Style	There is no attempt to integrate sources and background knowledge	There is little attempt to integrate sources and background knoweldge	There is a sustained integration of sources and background knowledge	
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****TIP:** Plan first by sketching out an outline or table. Start by going through every source in turn to find their points, adding your own, and adding background knowledge